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AWS Key Management Service

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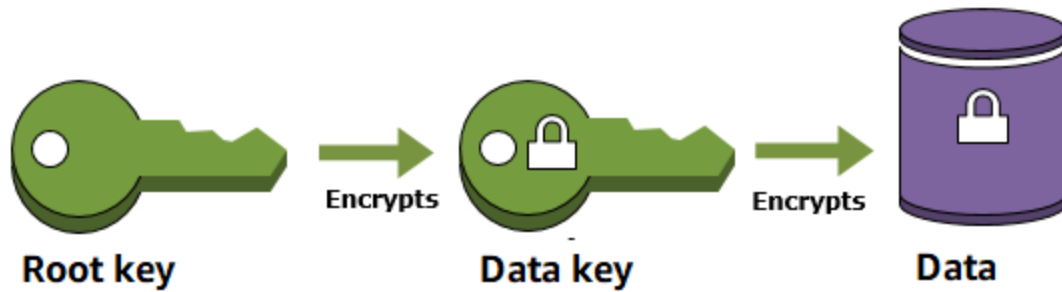
Focus mode

► On this page

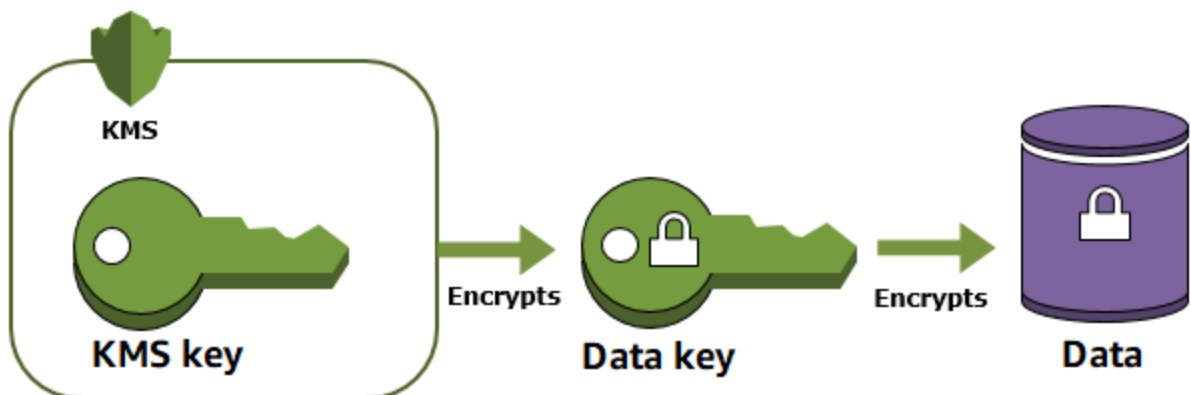
AWS Key Management Service (AWS KMS) is an AWS managed service that makes it easy for you to create and control the keys used to encrypt and sign your data. The AWS KMS keys that you create in AWS KMS are protected by [FIPS 140-3 Security Level 3 validated hardware security modules \(HSM\)](#) [↗ \(https://csrc.nist.gov/projects/cryptographic-module-validation-program/certificate/4884\)](https://csrc.nist.gov/projects/cryptographic-module-validation-program/certificate/4884). They never leave AWS KMS unencrypted. To use or manage your KMS keys, you interact with AWS KMS.

Why use AWS KMS?

When you encrypt data, you need to protect your encryption key. If you encrypt your key, you need to protect its encryption key. Eventually, you must protect the highest level encryption key (known as a *root key*) in the hierarchy that protects your data. That's where AWS KMS comes in.



AWS KMS protects your root keys. KMS keys are created, managed, used, and deleted entirely within AWS KMS. They never leave the service unencrypted. To use or manage your KMS keys, you call AWS KMS.



Additionally, you can create and manage [key policies](https://docs.aws.amazon.com/kms/latest/developerguide/key-policies.html) (<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/kms/latest/developerguide/key-policies.html>) in AWS KMS, ensuring that only trusted users have access to KMS keys.

AWS KMS in AWS Regions

The AWS Regions in which AWS KMS is supported are listed in [AWS Key Management Service Endpoints and Quotas](https://docs.aws.amazon.com/general/latest/gr/kms.html) (<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/general/latest/gr/kms.html>) . If an AWS KMS feature is not supported in an AWS Region that AWS KMS supports, the regional difference is described in the topic about the feature.

AWS KMS pricing

As with other AWS products, using AWS KMS does not require contracts or minimum purchases. For more information about AWS KMS pricing, see [AWS Key Management Service Pricing](https://aws.amazon.com/kms/pricing/) [↗](https://aws.amazon.com/kms/pricing/) (<https://aws.amazon.com/kms/pricing/>) .

AWS KMS service level agreement

AWS Key Management Service is backed by a [service level agreement](https://aws.amazon.com/kms/sla/) [↗](https://aws.amazon.com/kms/sla/) (<https://aws.amazon.com/kms/sla/>) that defines our service availability policy.

Did this page help you?

 Yes

 No

Get Started

[Provide feedback](https://docs.aws.amazon.com/getting-started/latest/feedback.html?hidden_service_name=Key+Management+Service+%28KMS%29&topic_url=https%3A%2F%2Fdocs.aws.amazon.com) (https://docs.aws.amazon.com/getting-started/latest/feedback.html?hidden_service_name=Key+Management+Service+%28KMS%29&topic_url=https%3A%2F%2Fdocs.aws.amazon.com)

[AWS Hands-On Tutorials](https://aws.amazon.com/getting-started/hands-on/) [↗](https://aws.amazon.com/getting-started/hands-on/)

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[AWS Solutions Library](https://aws.amazon.com/solutions/) [↗](https://aws.amazon.com/solutions/)

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[AWS Decision Guides](https://docs.aws.amazon.com/decision-guides/)

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Service Guides

[Choosing a generative AI service](https://docs.aws.amazon.com/decision-guides/latest/decision-guides/genai-guide.html)

(<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/decision-guides/latest/decision-guides/genai-guide.html>)

[AWS service guides](https://docs.aws.amazon.com/#products)

(<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/#products>)

[AWS CLI Tutorials on GitHub](https://github.com/aws-samples/sample-developer-tutorials) [↗](https://github.com/aws-samples/sample-developer-tutorials)

(<https://github.com/aws-samples/sample-developer-tutorials>)

Developer Tools

[AWS Code Example Library](https://docs.aws.amazon.com/code-library/latest/ug/what-is-code-library.html)

(<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/code-library/latest/ug/what-is-code-library.html>)

[AWS CLI](https://docs.aws.amazon.com/cli/) (<https://docs.aws.amazon.com/cli/>)

Helpful Links

[Download the AWS Docs MCP Server](https://github.com/awslabs/mcp/tree/main/src/aws-documentation-mcp-server) [↗](https://github.com/awslabs/mcp/tree/main/src/aws-documentation-mcp-server)

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